

...unless the world ends!

First things first, this is NOT the final issue of Digit. I didn't think I needed to spell it out, but enough subscribers called our helpdesk in concern when they received our sneak-peek mailer to necessitate the clarification. Also, thank you to all of you who contacted us out of concern, or those of you who saw the cover and were concerned, even if for a minute... it's a great feeling for everyone at Team Digit.

In preparation for this issue – which at first was a joke, but grew more concrete by the day as we researched – we went through a lot of conspiracy theory videos and websites out there. Not that we actually believe the world will end... but it was interesting to see the commitment that conspiracy theorists have to their beliefs. From people building homes in bunkers and their own backyards, to storing food supplies that would see them through a year or two... we came across a lot of weird but interesting ideas.

Mostly it all just seems like paranoia, or the general distrust in authorities such as governments and militaries. It doesn't help that science seems to fall in line as well, predicting a change in the solar cycles... people hear that and immediately think “supernova”, instead of just prettier northern lights, which is probably all that would happen anyway.

Is it just a human need to exaggerate? Is it some survival method our ancient ancestors developed, which manifests itself as boasting, lying, exaggerating, making it seem better/worse than it is, putting on spectacular shows, promising the world (and then delivering nothing), warning of an apocalypse... you get the drift.

Marketing is another way of doing the same, and yes, I'll be the first to admit, that we also market this magazine with our covers and cover stories. We have to, simply because everyone else does that too, and falling behind is never an option for anyone in a race – least of all for the one in first place.

Although the apocalypse may not come, I certainly believe that we're on the verge of a major shift as humanity. No, I'm not thinking floods and fire from above – just a maturing of people, being less gullible and ignoring the ‘faff’ (I'm told by the team I use that word a lot).

For India, it's education that's getting us there, and the growing prominence technology is taking in our lives. We're cutting

out the middleman, which is most noticeable in the travel and tourism industry – I haven't been to a ticket agent in at least 5 years, and probably neither have most of you. Online shopping is kicking off, and heck, in my home even groceries are bought online.

It's not just about buying things though. I can't remember the last time I clicked on a web advertisement on purpose, for example – though I'm sure there are millions who do (why else would companies allocate such huge budgets to the web?). However, thanks to being exposed to information, and more importantly, a larger network of people and their opinions. We're less likely to fall for marketing fluff as well, relying instead on unbiased reviews from sources such as Digit.

Technology and information equals knowledge, and that in turn equals power, transparency, greater savings and a better life. Being exposed to more makes us more tolerant of differences and less tolerant of idiocy, injustice and corruption.

Although the recent arrest over a casual statement on Facebook might mar the point I'm trying to make, it's thanks to the media and social networks that enough of us found out about it, which put pressure on the powers that be to right the wrongs.

Thanks to the inroads technology has made in our lives, kids these days are a lot smarter, and are finally looking to fulfill the dream that Digit has always had – for India to be known not just as consumers of technology, but creators of it.

Going into 2013, Digit will look to feature young inventors, cover more startups with commendable ideas and reward innovation with recognition. However, it's a social world, and we need your help. Make sure to write in to me if you're doing something interesting, or someone you know is, and I'll be happy to talk to you. Team Digit is also always happy to throw in a few suggestions, or ask you tough questions that could perhaps make your inventions or ideas better.

Here's looking forward to creating technology history in 2013... unless the world ends! 



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